KHYBER PAKHTUNKHAWA PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION (KPPSC)

PROVINCIAL MANAGEMENT SERVICE (PMS) COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION

SYLLABUS FOR OPTIONAL SUBJECT: INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS (100 MARKS)

> **Subject Group**: Group 6 (Optional Subjects)
>
> **Total Marks**: 100 Marks | **Time Allowed**: 3 Hours
>
> **Examination Pattern**: Descriptive / Subjective Examination (Attempt ANY 5 Questions out of 8, each carrying 20 Marks)
>
> **Statutory Combination Rule**: Candidates opting for *International Relations* **CANNOT** opt for *International Law*.

PART A: Foundational Theories, Core Concepts & The State System

1. **The Modern State System**:

- Historical evolution from the Treaty of Westphalia (1648) to the contemporary era.
- Core Westphalian features: Territorial integrity, internal sovereignty, external independence, and diplomatic recognition.
- Evolving forms and contemporary challenges: Supranational integration (EU), globalization, failed/fragile states, and the rise of non-state actors.

1. **International Relations as a Field of Study & Basic Approaches**:

- Scope and disciplinary evolution of International Relations.
- Foundational theoretical traditions:
- **Realism**: Classical Realism (Thucydides, Machiavelli, Morgenthau) vs. Structural Realism / Neorealism (Waltz, Mearsheimer - Defensive vs. Offensive).
- **Liberalism**: Classical Liberalism, Neoliberal Institutionalism (Keohane, Nye), Democratic Peace Theory, and Complex Interdependence.
- **Constructivism**: Social construction of anarchy, identity, norms, and culture (Alexander Wendt).
- **Critical & Marxist Perspectives**: Dependency Theory, World-Systems Analysis (Wallerstein).
- Core Concepts:
- **Power**: Elements of national power (tangible vs. intangible); Hard Power, Soft Power (Joseph Nye), and Smart Power.
- **Balance of Power**: Meaning, theoretical foundations, historical models, and instruments (alliances, armaments, buffer states, partition).
- **Imperialism**: Historical colonialism vs. modern imperialism; economic theories of Hobson and Lenin; neo-colonialism and dependency.
- **Nationalism**: Historical rise, civic vs. ethnic nationalism, anti-colonial nationalism, and contemporary populist resurgence.

1. **Interaction Between States**:

- **Diplomacy**: Evolution of diplomatic institutions, bilateral vs. multilateral diplomacy, summit diplomacy, public diplomacy, coercive diplomacy, and track-two channels.
- **International Law**: Nature, historical development, sources (treaties, customary law, general principles, judicial decisions), subjects, enforcement mechanisms, and systemic limitations in an anarchic order.
- **International Economic and Trade Linkages**: Mercantilism, economic liberalism, and structuralism; global trade regimes (WTO, GATT), international financial institutions (IMF, World Bank), trade wars, economic sanctions, and geo-economic competition.

PART B: Historical Evolution, Cold War Dynamics & Nuclear Security

1. **Evolution of the International System Since 1815**:

- The Concert of Europe (1815–1854): Balance of power and Congress diplomacy.
- The Bismarckian alliance system and the collapse of multipolar equilibrium.

1. **Major Global Conflicts & Systemic Transformations**:

- **World War I (1914–1918)**: Systemic causes (militarism, alliances, imperialism, nationalism), breakdown of crisis management, and the Paris Peace Settlement (Treaty of Versailles 1919).
- **World War II (1939–1945)**: Interwar instability, failure of collective security (League of Nations), appeasement, and total war dynamics.
- **Decolonization & The Third World**: Disintegration of European empires in Asia and Africa, post-colonial state vulnerabilities, and the emergence of the Global South.

1. **Cold War Geopolitics & Bipolar Confrontation**:

- Origins and structural nature of bipolarity (USA vs. USSR).
- Military Alliance Systems: NATO (1949), Warsaw Pact (1955), SEATO (1954), and CENTO (1955).
- Ideological warfare, proxy conflicts (Korea, Vietnam, Afghanistan), and crises (Berlin, Cuban Missile Crisis).
- The doctrine of **Peaceful Coexistence** and the era of **Détente** (1969–1979).
- **The Non-Aligned Movement (NAM)**: Origins (Bandung Conference 1955, Belgrade 1961), principles of non-alignment, historical achievements during the Cold War, and relevance in the post-Cold War multipolar era.

1. **Peace and Security in the Nuclear Age**:

- Theories of Peace and Security: Collective security vs. balance of power vs. deterrence.
- Nuclear Deterrence Theory: Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD), first-strike vs. second-strike stability, deterrence stability vs. instability paradox.
- Limited war, escalation control, and crisis management in nuclearized environments.
- Arms Control and Disarmament: Strategic Arms Limitation Talks (SALT I & II), START, Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT), and Comprehensive Nuclear-Test-Ban Treaty (CTBT).

PART C: Major Powers' Foreign Policies & Contemporary Global / Regional Flashpoints

1. **Foreign Policies of Superpowers and Major Powers**:

- **United States**: Grand strategy from Containment to Unipolarity; Pivot to Asia, Indo-Pacific Strategy, and strategic partnership with India.
- **Russian Federation**: Post-Soviet transition, revanchism, Near Abroad doctrine, NATO expansion pushback, and the Ukraine War (2022–present).

- **People's Republic of China**: Peaceful Rise, Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), global economic statecraft, and balance of power in Asia.
- **Special Reference to South Asia**: Great power competition and its direct strategic, political, and economic impacts on Pakistan and India.

1. **Contemporary Issues in Global & Regional Politics**:

- **The Shifting Global Order**: Decline of Western unipolarity, the Rise of China, multipolarity, and the expansion of counter-hegemonic blocs (BRICS, SCO).
- **South Asian Security Matrix**:
- India-Pakistan strategic rivalry, Kashmir dispute, and nuclearized crisis dynamics.
- Hydrological Security & Climate Change: The Indus Waters Treaty (1960), cross-border river disputes, and environmental challenges.
- Afghanistan Security Crisis: Taliban resurgence (August 2021), cross-border terrorism (TTP/ISKP), and security implications for Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan.
- **Middle Eastern Realignments**:
- The Abraham Accords (2020) and normalization of Arab-Israeli diplomatic ties.
- The Israel-Palestine Conflict, viability of the Two-State Solution, and post-October 7 regional fallout.
- Iran-Saudi reconciliation (Beijing-brokered 2023) and regional security rebalancing.
- **Geo-economics & Strategic Competition**:
- US-China Trade Wars, supply chain decoupling, and tariff diplomacy.
- The Indo-Pacific Strategy vs. China's Maritime Silk Road in the Indian Ocean.
- **Non-State Actors (NSAs) & Non-Traditional Security**:
- Transnational terrorism (ISIS, Al-Qaeda), insurgencies, and hybrid warfare.
- Global pandemics (Covid-19 "New Normal"), global supply chain fragilities, and multilateral institutional paralysis.
